Ryan McWay

Teaching Statement

Version: June 2, 2026

Contact Information

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Teaching Goal

My objective is to improve engagement with my students. This entails developing skills that adapt lecture material into learning activities. In my current teaching experience, I have found it difficult to maintain the attention of the modal student who is more preoccupied by their phone updates than my lecture material. My goal is to raise the opportunity cost for distractions.

Teaching Experience

Instructor

QMBE 3740	Data Mining	Bachelors	Hamline University	2026
ECON 294-05	Econ. of Sustainable Development	Bachelors	Macalester College	2026
ECON 3750	Behavioral & Exp. Economics	Bachelors	Hamline University	2025
APEC 1201	App. of Excel in Econ. and Mgmt.	Bachelors	University of Minnesota	2024
———	Applied Economics Math Review	Doctoral	University of Minnesota	2023

Teaching Assistant

APEC 3611	Env. and Nat. Res. Economics	Bachelors	University of Minnesota	2026
APEC 1101	Principles of Microeconomics	Bachelors	University of Minnesota	2025
FW 8452	Conservation Biology	Doctoral	University of Minnesota	2025
APEC 5032	Economic Data Analysis	Masters	University of Minnesota	2024
APEC 3003	Intro. to Applied Econometrics	Bachelors	University of Minnesota	2023
ECON 620	Graduate Econometrics	Masters	University of San Francisco	2020
ECON 427	Applied Econometrics Capstone	Bachelors	University of San Francisco	2020
ECON 312	Intermediate Macroeconomics	Bachelors	University of San Francisco	2020
ECON 111	Principles of Microeconomics	Bachelors	University of San Francisco	2020
ECON 615	Mathematics for Economists	Masters	University of San Francisco	2019
ECON 112	Principles of Macroeconomics	Bachelors	University of San Francisco	2019

Guest Lectures

APEC 3003	Intro. to Applied Econometrics	Bachelors	University of Minnesota	2023
ECON 312	Intermediate Macroeconomics	Bachelors	University of San Francisco	2020
ECON 615	Mathematics for Economists	Masters	University of San Francisco	2019

Brief Teaching Philosophy Statement

My general teaching philosophy is to limit barriers to learning and increasing learning retention. I achieve this by providing a variety of in-person and online mediums through which my students can engage with the material. The design of my course material continuously repeats the core foundations as new material is presented so students can re-evaluate the tenants of the material via repeated exposure in various contexts.

Synergistic Activities

1. **Diversity, Equity and Inclusion.** I have engaged with the promotion of diversity, equity, and inclusion (DEI) both within and outside my academic institutions to advance student diversity and increase inclusion in the classroom. Previously, I have been a student representative on the DEI Committee for the University of Minnesota's Institute for Social Research and Data Innovation (ISRDI). And I currently sit on the Inclusive Excellence (EI) committee as a student representative for the Applied Economics department. In both instances, created support tools for students as well as advocated on their behalf. Additionally, I have acted as a mentor through the GAIN Network to improve PhD applications for prospective students from Sub-Saharan Africa.

2. **Organizing Student Research.** I actively engage with the promotion of student research. For my PhD program, I organized both the bi-weekly APEC student seminar that highlighted on-going work by students as well as developed a bi-weekly APEC skills workshop to bring in workshops on statistical, technical, and professional skills missing from our core curriculum. Further, I have acted as an organizer for the PhD - Economic Virtual Seminar (PhD-EVS) which hosts weekly presentations by PhD students increasing dialogue across departments.